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HEY YOU!



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

The hay is baled, rolled, and ready to be jumped on at Adams Farm in Cumberland, R.I. The farm has plenty to offer during the season, including corn mazes, farm animals, and pumpkin picking.

In study of ex-NFL players, 75% had CTE

New numbers provide better idea of prevalence

By Allyson Chiu and Aaron Leibowitz
GLOBE STAFF

Nearly three-quarters of all NFL players who died during a recent 15-year period had the degenerative brain disease known as CTE, according to new research published Wednesday in the peer-reviewed journal JAMA Network Open.

The new study is a refinement of research that some of the authors published in late August. It covers a larger number of players over a longer period, including those whose brains were not donated for research, and aimed to arrive at a more accurate estimate of CTE than the earlier work.

"It's the paper that the field has been waiting on for a long time," said Dr. Ramon Diaz-Arrastia, a neurology professor at the University of Pennsylvania Perelman School of Medicine, who was not involved in the new study.

Julia Gallini, the lead author of the study and a PhD candidate at Boston University School of Public Health, said the results do not necessarily mean that 75 percent of current NFL players will develop CTE.

"We don't know that number," she said. "The magnitude of this number, though, is very concerning. It still tells us we need to be concerned about the risk of current players developing CTE."

CTE, Page A10



GLOBE FILE/1973

Len St. Jean, a Patriot in the 1960s and '70s, decided to donate his brain to Boston University. He was found to have Stage 3 CTE.

Sort of bad, it's oh so good

Fermenters spread the word about their funky feasts

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE — When you're all in on homemade fermented foods, you sometimes have to take a leap of faith.

You meet strangers, pick up their jars filled with pungent vegetables in bright red, green, or beige, and scoop little aromatic piles onto a plate.

You do this knowing the risks. These are jars of kimchi green tomatoes and homemade kefir drinks in which bacterial colonies have been allowed to feast, in kitchens you have not seen. And yet, you sample.

Such is the bonding experience of dropping in at the Somerville Fermentation Club, a hangout for people with a bubbling interest in the millennia-old food preparation, and eager to experience shades of tang and funk that less adventurous eaters might never know.

"For me, there is something really exciting about living foods. They're alive. You watch them transform on your countertop," said Flora Spivak, 37, a club cofounder.

The club met for the first time at Somerville's Aeronaut brewery on Monday and plans to gather there monthly. It's an offshoot of the extraordinarily popular Somerville Fermentation Festival, which Spivak also founded and which, in August, drew a crowd of thousands.

On Monday, they came carting pickle jars, trays of miso cookies, bottles of fragrant liquids, and hunks of sourdough bread wrapped in foil.

(They were forbidden from bringing kombucha, the fermented tea drink, because it can contain alcohol, and as free-flowing as Somerville is, a brewery can't have people passing around homemade hooch.)

At-home fermenters can't always so easily find willing taste testers in their regular lives.

FERMENTATION, Page A10

'My wife and I came to the conclusion that God has a path for us to serve.'

MICHAEL MINOGUE

Shaped by religion, Minogue puts his faith into deeds

By Chris Van Buskirk
GLOBE STAFF

Michael Minogue stood before a crowd inside an American Legion post earlier in October to talk about health care when he started to riff instead on family and faith.

His father was a Navy veteran who moved the family to New Jersey after his military service. But as one of four children from an Irish Catholic family, Minogue said his mother hoped he, or perhaps his brother, would eventually find an even higher calling.

"To become priests," Minogue said.

The church, he said, wasn't his path. But Minogue's faith has nevertheless remained a driving force in his life, shaping how he's donated some of his considerable wealth and, he said, guiding his decision to run for Massachusetts' highest office.

"My wife and I came to the conclusion that God has a path for us to serve," he said of his decision to run during a recent campaign stop in Shirley.

Minogue references his faith when he talks about his leadership style — "No circumstance is hopeless, especially with God," he said in a video produced last year by his consulting firm — and about how it's influenced him as a parent of five children.

His family has a "code of conduct" that emphasizes "faith in service to others and to God," which he carries on a card in his wallet. He said he prays daily, and routinely references his religion on the campaign trail, describing himself as someone who looks to God for guidance.

Minogue is a West Point graduate who deployed to Iraq in the early 1990s, where he earned a Bronze Star during Operation Desert Storm. He worked at GE Healthcare after the military but is likely best known for serving as the chief executive of Abiomed, a Danvers-based heart-pump maker,

MINOGUE, Page A7

For Sununu (John E., that is), the family ties work both ways

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

LACONIA, N.H. — You could be forgiven for confusing two middle-aged politicians with the same forehead and the same last name. It's happened to the chyron writers on national news shows and even a local debate moderator.

At the pumpkin festival here on Saturday, amid the wafting scent of kettlecorn and the blast of '80s rock, a few voters fell into the trap, too.

"Oh, I thought you were Chris," Donka Facciolo apologized after greeting Republican Senate candidate John E. Sununu, warmly, by the name of his younger brother.

Family recognition in New Hampshire is no doubt helping John E. Sununu — not to be mistaken for his younger brother Chris, who until recently was the governor of the state, nor his father, John H. Sununu, who much less recently was the governor of the state — as he runs for the US Senate, a seat he last held almost two decades ago. The political dynasty is front and center as Sununu navigates a difficult national environment for Republicans in his close-fought race against Democratic Representative Chris Pappas.

The irony for political operatives who know the family well is that the two brothers are very different in disposition. And, of course, that John had a political career first.

"If they didn't share the same last name, I'm not sure you would guess they're actually brothers, because they're really different people," said Fergus Cullen, who was chair of the New Hampshire GOP when John E. Sununu last ran for office in 2008.

"John E. is likable, but Chris was more likable," Cullen added. "He was more of an outgoing people person. Chris never got tired of the third-graders' field trip when they're visiting the State House."

Back at the pumpkin festival, as she bought a

SUNUNUS, Page A7

As Ohio struggles, familiar face looks better and better

2 years after losing Senate seat, Brown leads in polls

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

MARTINS FERRY, Ohio — For decades, John Saunders watched in agony as his East Ohio riverfront town of about 6,000 people suffered the repercussions of what he calls "an industrial death sentence."

As jobs in nearby steel mills and coal mines dried up due to outsourcing, so, too did support for the Democratic Party.

"People lost their jobs. Trump was the answer," concedes Saunders, a lifelong Democrat and longtime staff representative for United Steelworkers Local 1238.

The interceding years, however, brought a litany of broken promises from President Trump and his party. Instead of bringing down the cost of living, Trump's policies have increased it. The president who pledged to keep the country out of foreign wars started one in Iran, causing the price of oil to skyrocket. Now, Saunders feels Ohioans "are looking at a different direction."

OHIO, Page A6



Dolores Huerta, who with Cesar Chavez founded what became the United Farm Workers and led strikes and boycotts in the 1960s and '70s that unionized many California table-grape growers, died at 96. She became a kind of Mexican American folk hero, depicted in murals. **C9.**

After weeks of mounting pressure, Dartmouth College's provost resigned over his use of AI tools to generate and publish writing. **B1.**

The Federal Reserve held interest rates steady, despite no recent progress on getting inflation down. **D1.**

The Milwaukee Brewers won their first-ever world championship, taking care of the Rays with a 4-1 win in Game 5. **C1.**

With little FDA input, the Trump administration acted to ease access to unproven peptide drugs favored by Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. **A5.**

Goblin it up

Thursday: Warming again. High 66-71. Low 54-59.

Friday: And again. High 68-73. Low 43-48.

High tide: 1:48 a.m., 1:58 p.m.

Sunrise: 7:14 Sunset: 5:41

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

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